



Striking a Balance

Running your own business can be exciting, challenging, and highly rewarding, but it is important not to ignore other aspects of your life. Striking a healthy work-life balance is essential.

Setting boundaries

Starting your new business is both exciting and highly demanding. You have to put in time and effort, but long hours can take their toll, affecting your relationships and your health. Try to draw clear boundaries between work and leisure. To create a good work-life balance, aim for routine working hours, starting and finishing at the same times each day, and make sure you take a lunch break. If you are based at home, try to mark the transition from work to leisure with an end-of-work ritual, such as going for a swim, walk, or jog.

Set boundaries around physical spaces to separate work and home areas. You might want to establish a dedicated workspace at home, ideally a separate room or another area reserved solely for work. If you have sufficient resources, you could consider building a shed to work in or renting an office, studio, or business space elsewhere.

If you have employees, consider how you can help maintain their work-life balance, too. This may mean a flexible approach that focuses more on their productivity than on being present for a set number of hours per day. This approach also helps build a happy, dynamic team.

Work-life balance

While your business may suffer if you are distracted by personal worries, your partner or family may also feel neglected if you are always working. It is possible to get the balance right. Agreed routines and good communication can ensure that your work life and home life complement each other rather than clash head-on.

MANAGING STRESS

- **Take regular breaks** throughout the day.
- **Exercise** to clear your head, relieve stress, and open your mind to new ideas.
- **Do not neglect your diet.** Junk food causes sugar spikes, which can leave you feeling hungry and tired.
- **Practice meditation** or mindfulness, together with deep-breathing exercises to relax your body and mind.
- **Stick to a sleep routine**, based on your natural sleep-wake cycle, to ensure you get the rest you need.

WORK LIFE

- Plan out each day; carefully time-manage meetings and set specific times for tasks like checking emails.
 - Try different ways to improve productivity.
 - Delegate when it makes sense to do so.

